

Comic Con: Are you part of the revolution?

Not quite in the league of the original fan fest held at San Diego, California, every year, but the Comic Con movement (the largest gathering of fans of comics, games and movies dressed as their beloved characters) has received good support in India over the past couple of years. Comic Con events take place in Delhi, Mumbai, and Bangalore every year, to the best of our knowledge, and we've attended the Delhi and Mumbai editions on more than one occasion.

We had a ton of fun attending the 2015 edition of Comic Con Mumbai, for example, as it saw a good turnout of attendees dressed in a variety of characters (<http://dgit.in/ComicC2015>). Not only was the crowd interesting but also the various booths and guests of honour talking about their love of all things comics, video games and movies. What's interesting to note is that last year's event was definitely better than the year before last, and this is evident at all Comic Con events happening across India.



to Syrinx, "This is a very common misconception. Every year, comic con gathers over 200 cosplayers, each day for 3 days in every city it has an event in. We are definitely not lacking in numbers". Even Pracheta agrees that it's not the numbers that are lacking, but rather the recognition. Cosplay has only recently gained popularity in the country, according to SkunkWorks, and this is only the beginning as it's growing at a rapid rate.

Then why is it that cosplay isn't too mainstream despite the numbers? Awareness is the key. Despite how awfully kung-fu-master cliched that sounds, it's true. There are many people who don't even know what cosplay is or aren't familiar with what it is and what is involved in it. Some suggested more events across the country, and perhaps even broadcasting it for others to see. This way people can even observe the amounts of hard work that goes into the making of these costumes.

Others however believed that cosplay didn't necessarily need to be mainstream to be enjoyable. That's not the primary goal of cos-

player, who at the crux of it all just want to enjoy himself or herself and have a good time. Sure, being acknowledged for it and having more like-minded people is never a bad thing.

So what's the scope for cosplaying in India? Can we do it professionally? Is it a viable full-time job? The short answer, no. The long answer.. is also no. Very few cosplayers actually make a living out cosplaying. And that's around the world. So when it isn't a viable profession worldwide, India has a long ways to go. But you can never tell, times can

change and maybe it could become a viable profession in the future, but as of right now, it's still just a hobby, and an expensive one at that. However, that doesn't mean that certain aspects of the cosplaying process can't be used to create viable professions. Being able to make your own dresses and props isn't a joke. Also other industries such as fashion and entertainment media will welcome you with open arms.

Lastly we asked if they had any tips for anyone who was maybe inspired by this article to take up cosplaying. And boy did they have a lot to say! The first and foremost thing every one of them had to say was not to be afraid of it. If it's the budget that's intimidating you, there's always cheaper alternatives and if you're creative you can always find a way. Overall it's definitely an expensive hobby to have but there are always workarounds. Don't be afraid to make mistakes, accuracy is not what's important. Don't let anyone tell you who you should or shouldn't have cosplayed as. What's most important is that you have fun doing what you're doing! *



You can never have enough deadpools at any convention